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DDoS Attack Puts Code Spaces Out of Business

CodeSpaces.com closed its doors this week, following a 12-hour security breach that completely wiped its servers.

By [Stephanie Mlot](#) June 19, 2014





Days after Feedly and Evernote were briefly forced offline by hackers demanding a ransom payment, a code-hosting service was run out of business by a similar scheme.

CodeSpaces.com closed its doors this week, following a security breach that began with a distributed denial-of-service (DDoS) attack, and ended 12 hours later after an attempt to extort money from the company.



No stranger to DDoS attacks, Code Spaces thought it could handle the situation, but the situation quickly spiraled out of control.

On Tuesday, an unauthorized person—not believed to be employed by the site—gained access to Code Spaces's Amazon EC2 control panel. When the team fought back, the hacker deleted "most of our data, backups, machine configurations and offsite backups," the company said.

"Code Spaces will not be able to operate beyond this point," [an online notice](#) said, citing the price of resolving the issue, as well as the expected cost of refunding paying customers. This week's attack "will put Code Spaces in [an] irreversible position both financially and in terms of ongoing credibility."

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"All that we have to say at this point is how sorry we are to both customers and to the people who make a living at Code Spaces for the chain of events that lead us here," the company said.

Users can expect more details once Code Spaces sorts out its customers' needs. Those who have stored data on the site can email support@codespaces.com with an account URL, and if you're lucky, some remaining crumbs will be returned.



For more, watch PCMag Live in the video below, which the Code Spaces dilemma.

It's been a banner month for DDoS attacks: Evernote suffered a blow last week, but was back on its feet within a few hours. [Feedly wasn't so lucky](#), however. The RSS service was hit twice in two days, though the company promised user data remained safe.

Similarly, Ancestry.com just recovered today [from a three-day bout of DDoS](#), in which the site was overloaded with traffic and crashed. No user information was compromised.



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